



ROSSHOLME KENYA



The 266 pupils of Rossholme School, located within the Kiambiu Slum in Nairobi, Kenya, were delighted to be back at school on 4th January after nearly a year's absence. Joyce Aruga, the Headteacher, her seven teaching staff, Cook and Security Guard, were also really happy to welcome back these noisy, exuberant, happy children.



After nearly a year of closure, the school admitted a number of new pupils. Several other schools in the area have closed because they received no income to pay rent for their premises or to pay their staff during lockdown. Joyce and her staff were extremely grateful for the fact that we continued to send money out every month so we did not lose our premises.



For many of our children, school provides their only decent meal of the day. As well as the educational benefits and food, Rossholme provides a SECURE environment for them during the day and uniform to wear. It promotes a real love of learning, where the children develop a thirst for knowledge and it engenders a true community spirit.

Life during lockdown was certainly challenging for both parents and children. Many parents had to make a difficult decision: work illegally or watch their children die of starvation. A generous donation from the US enabled Joyce to buy food parcels for families she knew were in desperate need. She sent out messages for parents to collect parcels at particular times but she was inundated with parents and others from all over the slum area, queuing to get in first in case food ran out; good news of food supplies certainly travels fast.



Ever resourceful, Joyce thought again. She negotiated with the local supermarket to get food vouchers which were then given out in person to needy families. A significant amount of school uniform was donated to the school through one of our supporters, Mrs Libby Tidswell. A former teacher at the original Rossholme School in Somerset, Libby has worked tirelessly to raise money and to support the school. A Royal Air Force contact, Wing Commander Neil Hope, enabled us to get it all flown out there and the children were so thrilled to receive them; it might not all match the navy and yellow school colours but uniform gives the children such a sense of pride. Through Neil, who organises the RAF based 'Taking Football to Africa and beyond Charitable Appeal', we also received a significant number of red T-shirts and footballs from Leicester City Football Club.



**ROSSHOLME
KENYA**

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Registered as a Charitable
Incorporated Organisation
(CIO), Charity No 1178553

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For further info please
contact Judy Webb
judy@rossholmeinkenya.org

FUNDRAISING

We are a registered
charity (number 1178553)
which means that Gift
Aid can be claimed on
donations made by UK
tax payers. Donations can
now be made through
CAFDonate which can
be accessed through our
website:

www.rossholmeinkenya.org

CAFDonate will also
process the GiftAid or,
alternatively, if donations
are made directly to the
charity, a GiftAid form can
be downloaded from the
website and returned to:
judy@rossholmeinkenya.org
£625 received from HMRC
this year!

We aim to publish a
Newsletter about every
6 months so, if you know
of anyone else who may
be interested in receiving
one by email, please let us
know. In line with GDPR,
we need permission for
names to be on a mailing
list but we assure you
that it is not published
anywhere; it is retained
only by us and all emails
are BCC'd so no list of
emails is available.



Letter from Joyce

Dear Rossholme trustees,

Thank you so much for your love and care. We love you all very much. You always make us feel great and loved.

In March, we received donations of clothes and balls from Libby (Tidswell) and Neil Hope (RAF). The children were very happy. We're very grateful for your kindness and generosity.

The term went on smoothly. We had enough water at school and enough hand-washing points.

We had to use a thermogun every morning to check students' temperatures and we also made sure that they washed their hands before getting into classes. Our students are now on school break 'till May 10th and we hope they will all stay safe 'till they return to school.

Covid_19 is still hitting us very hard. There's a third wave of Corona virus in Kenya. Right now Nairobi and its surrounding four counties are under lockdown until further notice. We're grateful that the lockdown came after we had closed schools for April holiday.

We also thank God that we've not had any cases of Covid at Rossholme. We're really hoping that, by 10th May, things will be better for us to resume school.

*Love & Many Blessings,
Joyce & the Rossholme Teachers
& cook & students*

Family Update

Joyce's husband, Jacob, is now employed as an Education Officer in Nakuru County. This means he has to travel some 3 hours by bus on Monday mornings and returns on Fridays for the weekend. Government employment is more secure and better paid but, combined with parenthood of their 2 year old son, Doug, and the amount of time Joyce spends in school, it does demonstrate their commitment to Rossholme. 9th April was actually Doug's 2nd birthday; I sent birthday greetings but birthdays are not celebrated in the same way as they are here in UK and other wealthy nations. Joyce tells me she may get him a cake next year! When I first met Joyce, she had no idea of the actual date of her own birthday; her passport indicated it had been a couple of days before so we celebrated anyway...

Covid Update

News reports emanating from Kenya indicate that the virus situation has deteriorated quite significantly. Joyce's letter tells of the third wave and the fact that Nairobi and other areas, including Kiambu, are in lockdown again. Hopefully, the situation will improve to enable the children to return to school on 10th May.

COMPUTERS NEEDED



ICT has now become part of the Kenyan school curriculum so we are keen to ensure that Rossholme children are not left behind. We do, at least, have an electricity supply in our current premises and we are pursuing contacts for the installation of a reliable broadband supply and an Internet Network. We are, therefore, appealing for laptops (less than 5 years old) which will make a real difference to the children's learning – and to the teachers' teaching. Any spare laptops will be gratefully received!

Rossholme School in Kenya is registered as a UK Charity (No 1178553), full information is available on the website: www.rossholmeinkenya.org, including a link to CAF Donate though which donations can be made.



<https://smile.amazon.co.uk/ch/1178553-0>

Amazon Smile: If you do have an Amazon account and you do not currently take advantage of their offer to donate 0.5% of all sales (less VAT and Shipping fees) to a registered charity, do please click the link <https://smile.amazon.co.uk/ch/1178553-0> which shows you how easy it is to do and enables Rossholme in Kenya to benefit. We have already received £118.35 through this scheme, which is a great boost to our funds and costs you nothing.

We are very grateful to Jayne and Jim Murray of Media Edge UK, (www.mediaedgeuk.co.uk) who have produced this, and all our Newsletters, pro bono.

Their daughter, Katie, is a former pupil of Rossholme School in Somerset.